



US 20250280851A1

(19) **United States**

(12) **Patent Application Publication**
LEE et al.

(10) **Pub. No.: US 2025/0280851 A1**

(43) **Pub. Date: Sep. 11, 2025**

(54) **GUMMY CONFECTIONERY-COATED
NON-EDIBLE CONTAINER**

(30) **Foreign Application Priority Data**

Aug. 9, 2019 (NZ) 756215

(71) Applicant: **ZURU EDGE LIMITED**, Kowloon
(HK)

Publication Classification

(72) Inventors: **Chung Hyun LEE**, Seoul (KR); **David
Johnston SMITH**, Auckland (NZ);
**Diwata Katrina Dinglasa
SANTILLAN**, Auckland (NZ); **Ethan
Luke HARROLD**, Auckland (NZ);
Ethan HUTCHINSON, Dairy Flat
(NZ)

(51) **Int. Cl.**
A23G 3/54 (2006.01)
B65D 8/00 (2006.01)
(52) **U.S. Cl.**
CPC *A23G 3/545* (2013.01); *B65D 11/02*
(2013.01)

(21) Appl. No.: **19/216,583**

(57) **ABSTRACT**

(22) Filed: **May 22, 2025**

Related U.S. Application Data

(62) Division of application No. 17/632,165, filed on Feb.
1, 2022, filed as application No. PCT/SG2020/
050461 on Aug. 7, 2020, now Pat. No. 12,336,548.

A confectionery product comprising of a layer of gummy
confectionery, made up of one or more sections, which coat
a non-edible object or container. This container is purposed
to house a children's toy and support the layer of confec-
tionery. Methods of preparing the confectionery-coated
object also are provided.

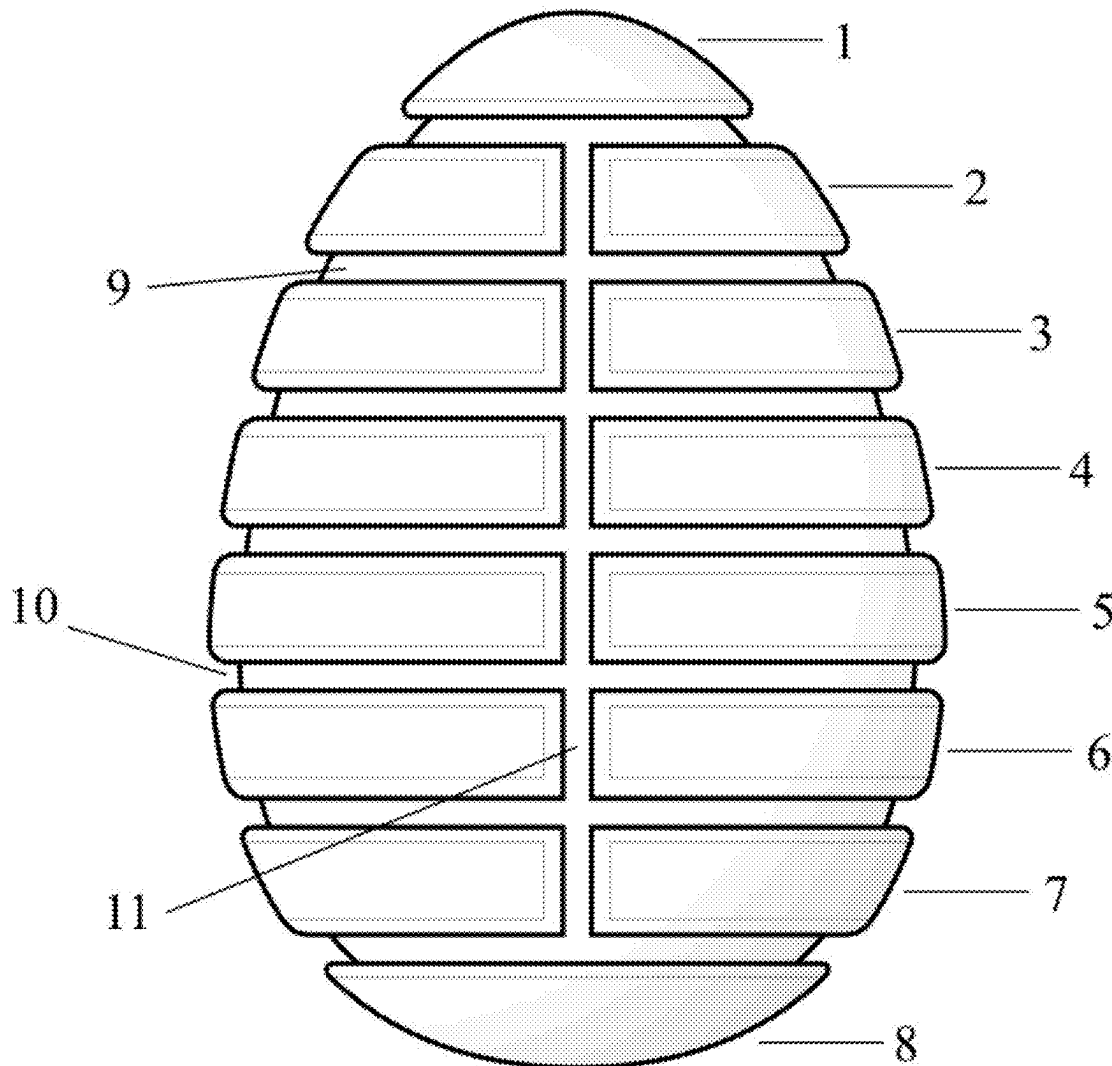


Fig. 1

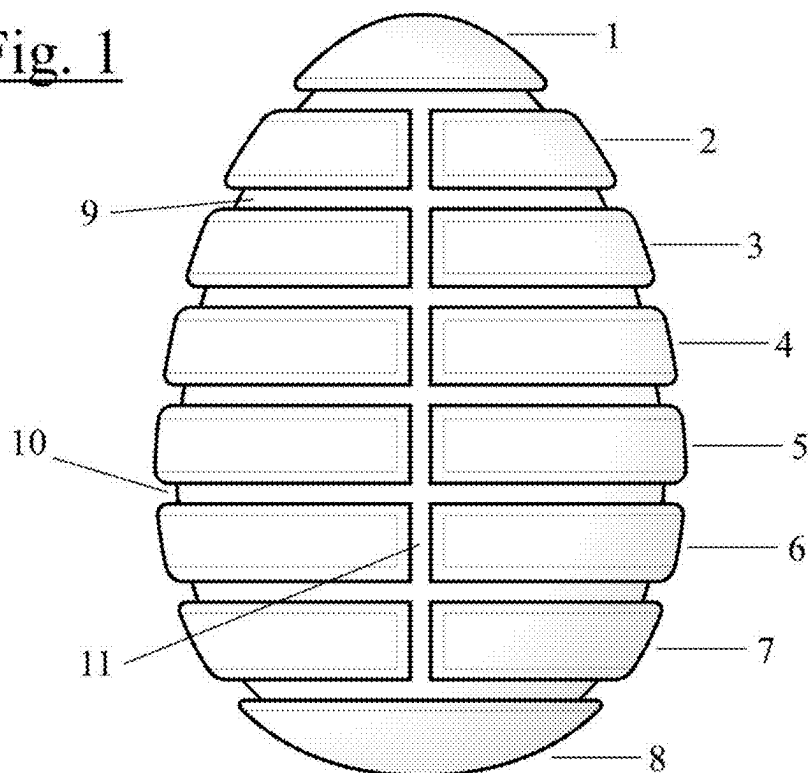


Fig. 2

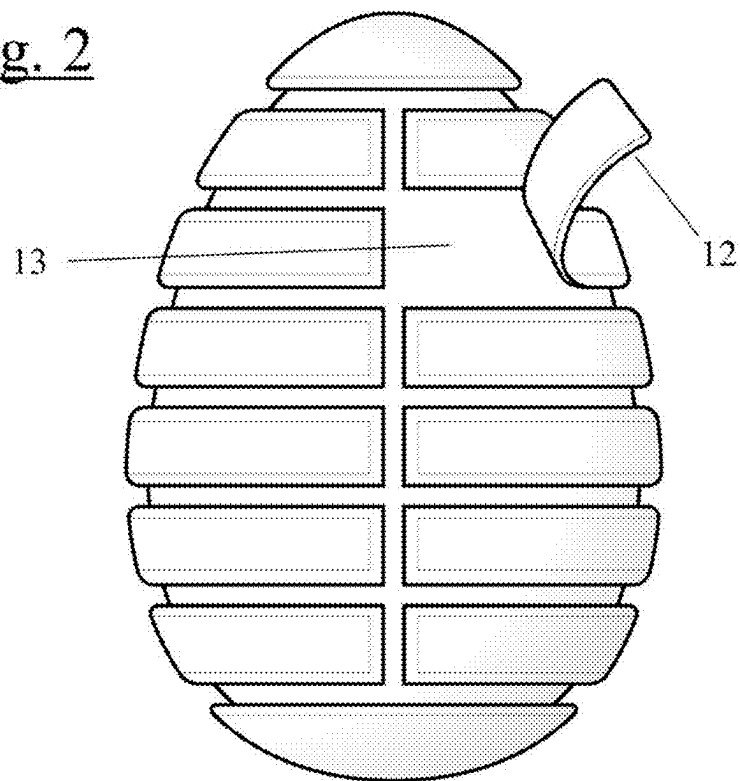


Fig. 3

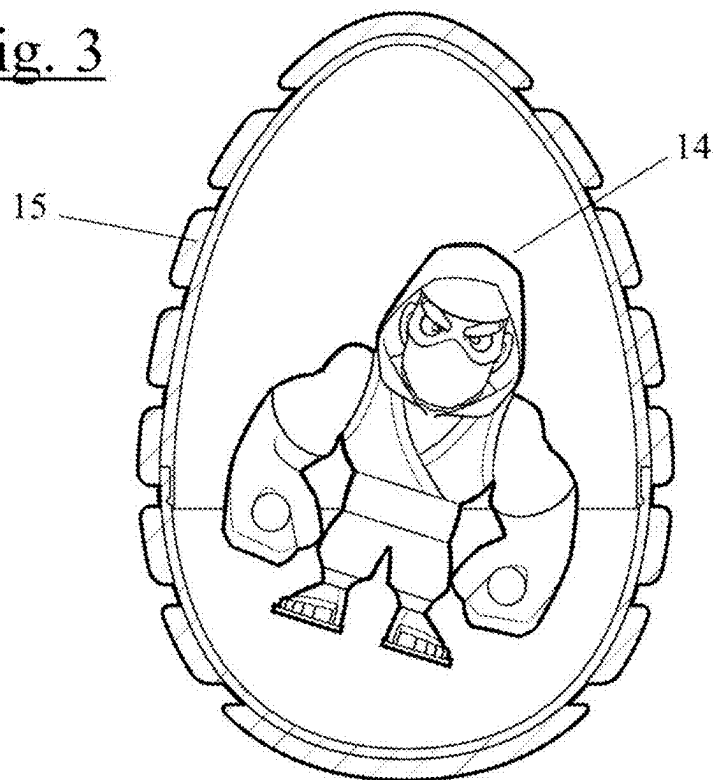


Fig. 4

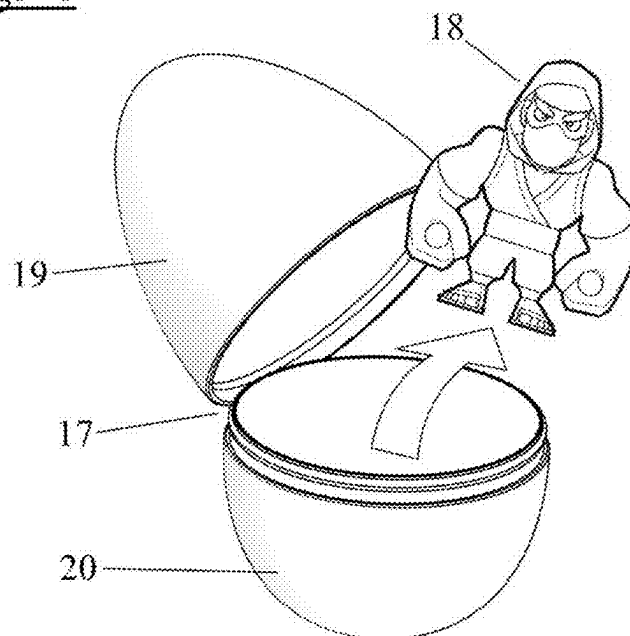


Fig. 5

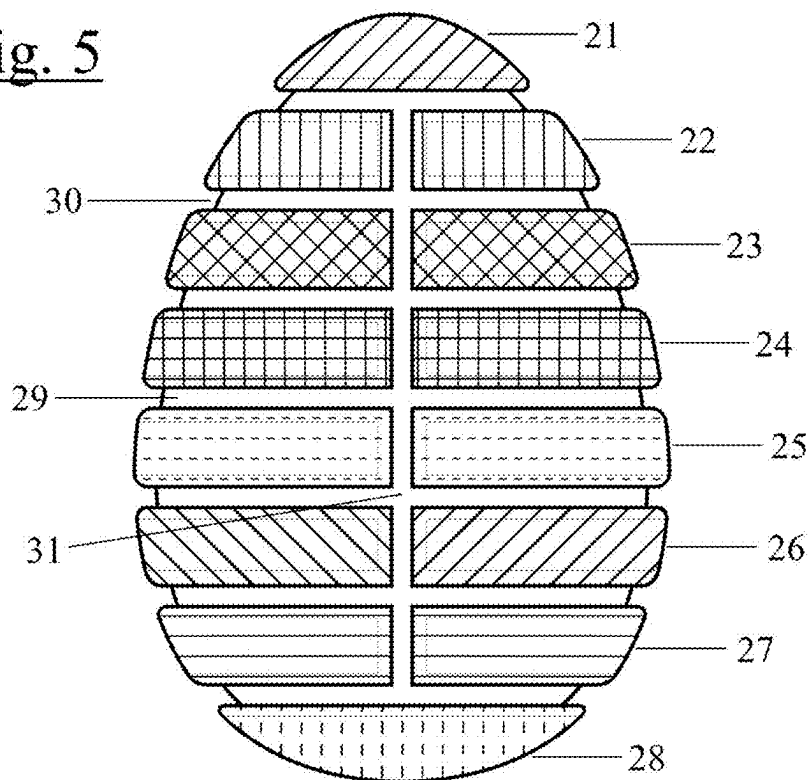


Fig. 6

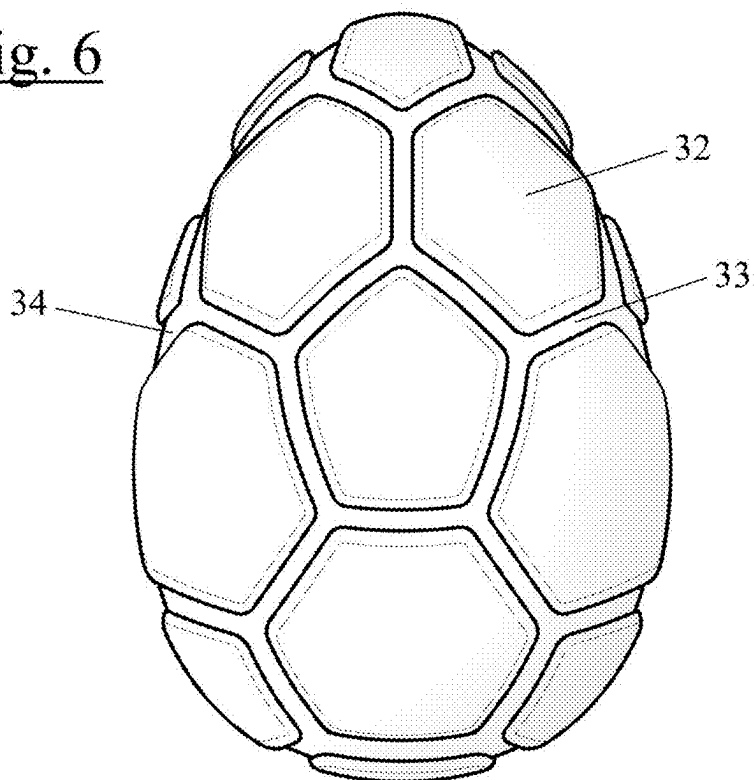


Fig. 7

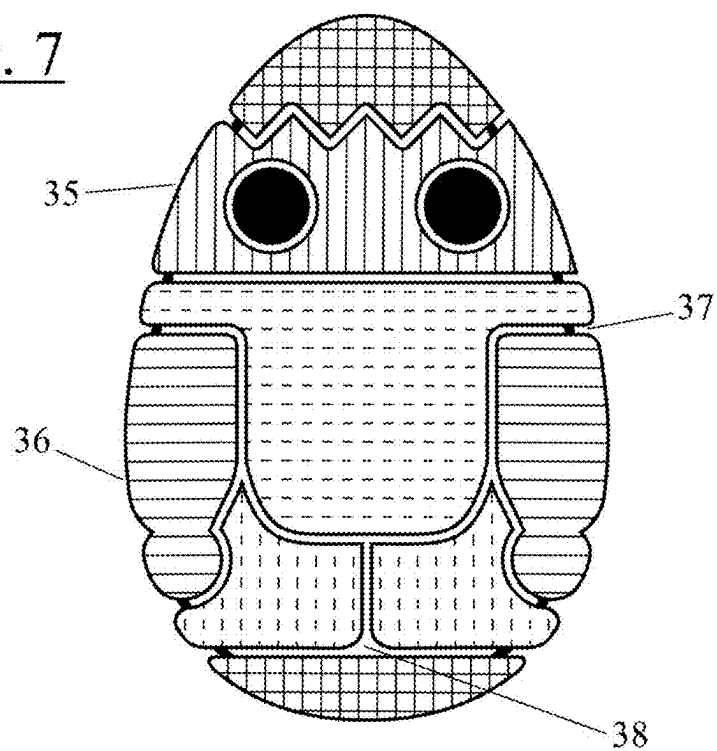


Fig. 8

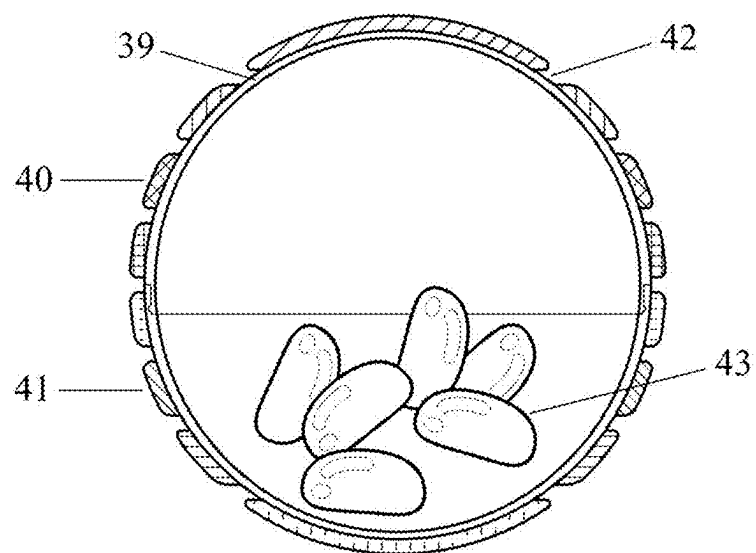


Fig. 9

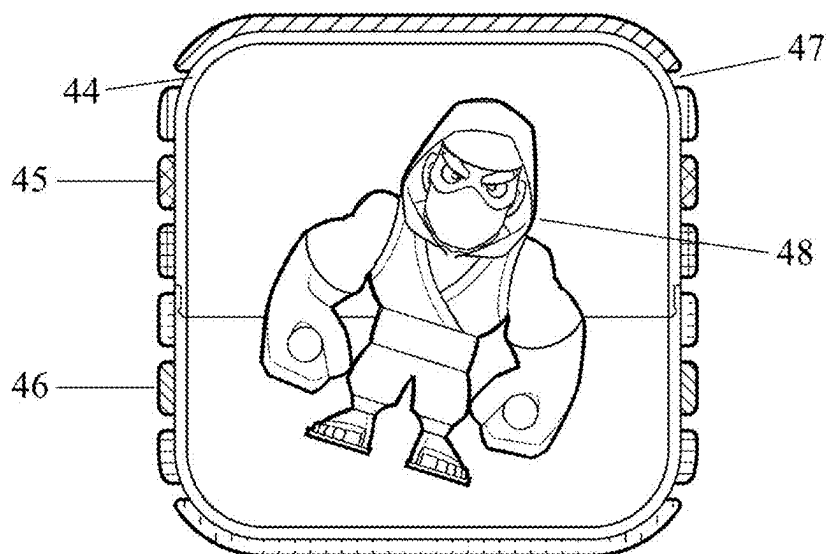


Fig. 10

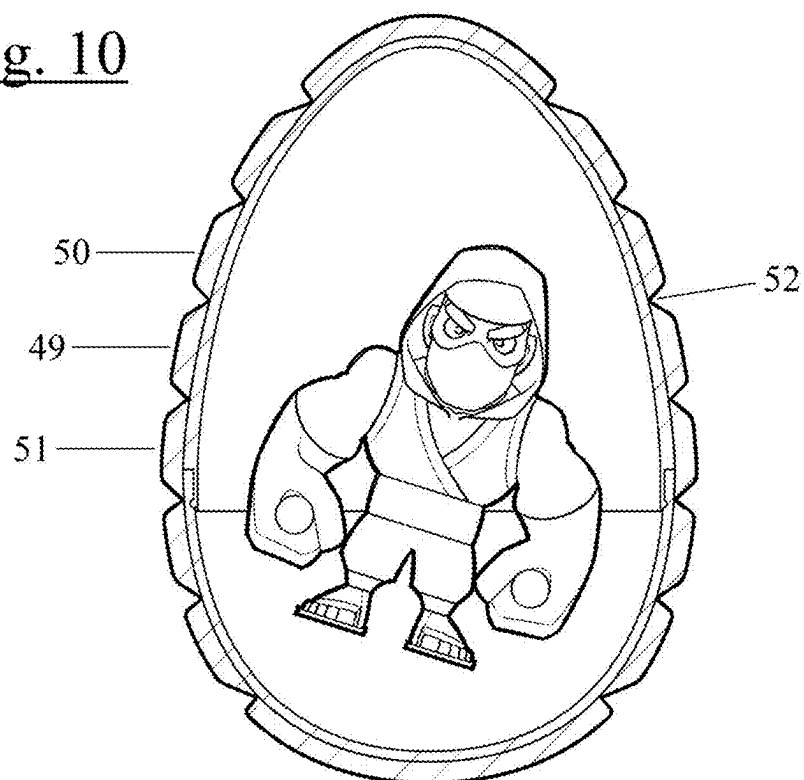


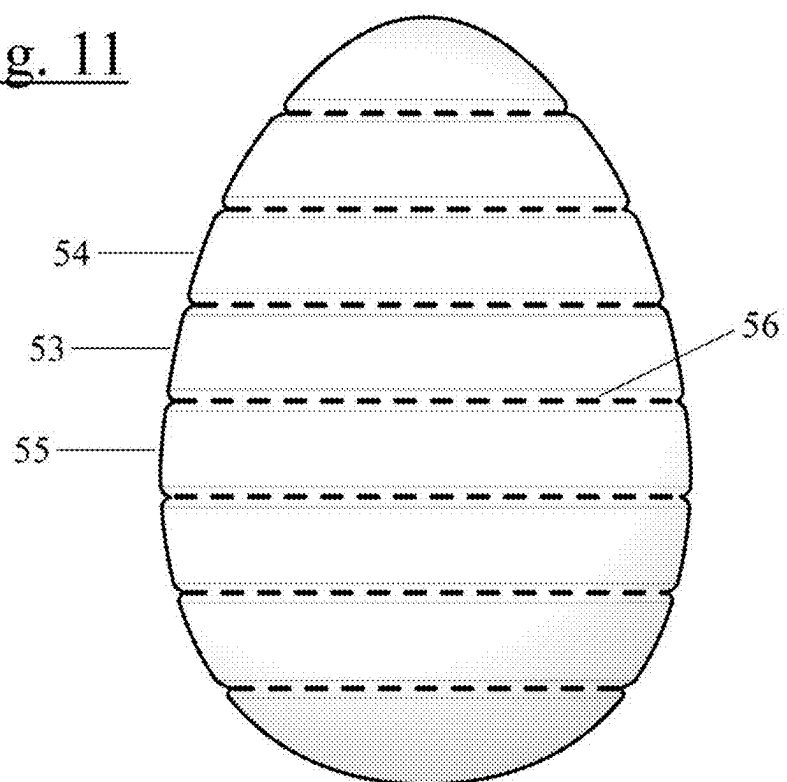
Fig. 11

Fig. 12

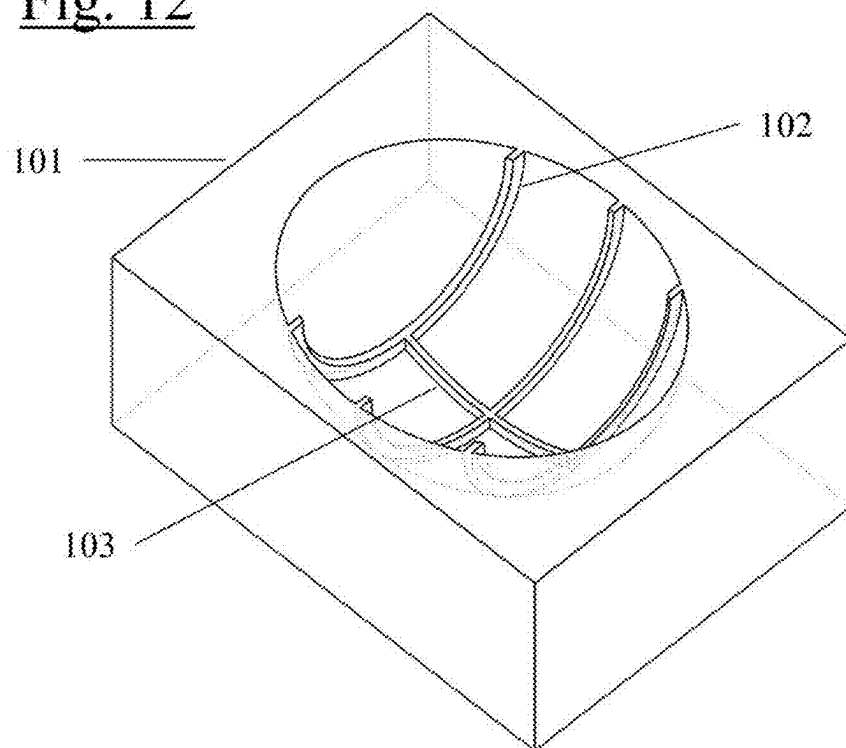


Fig. 13

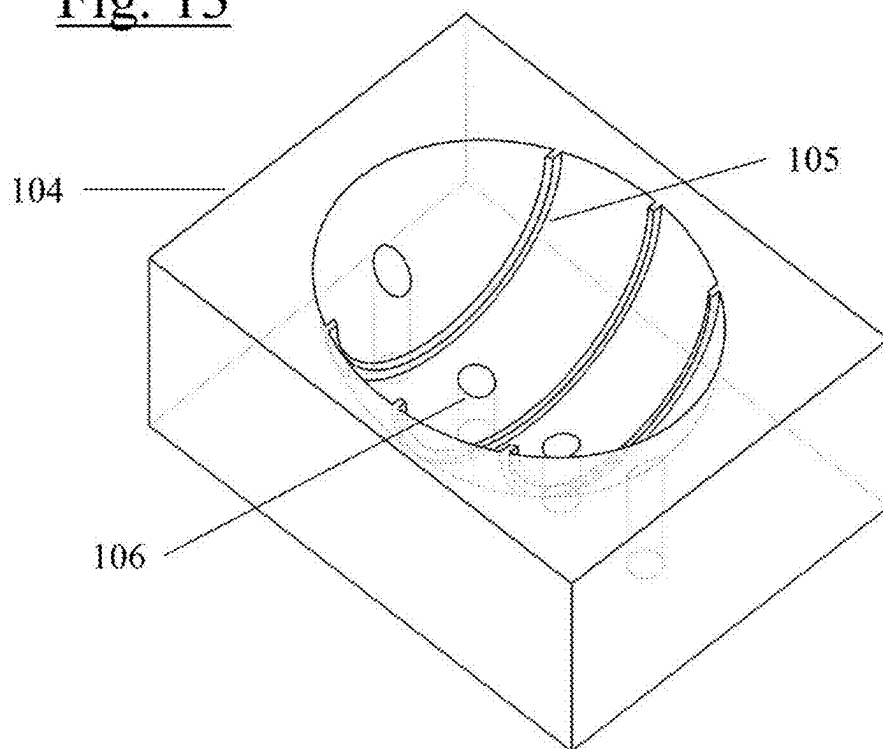


Fig. 14

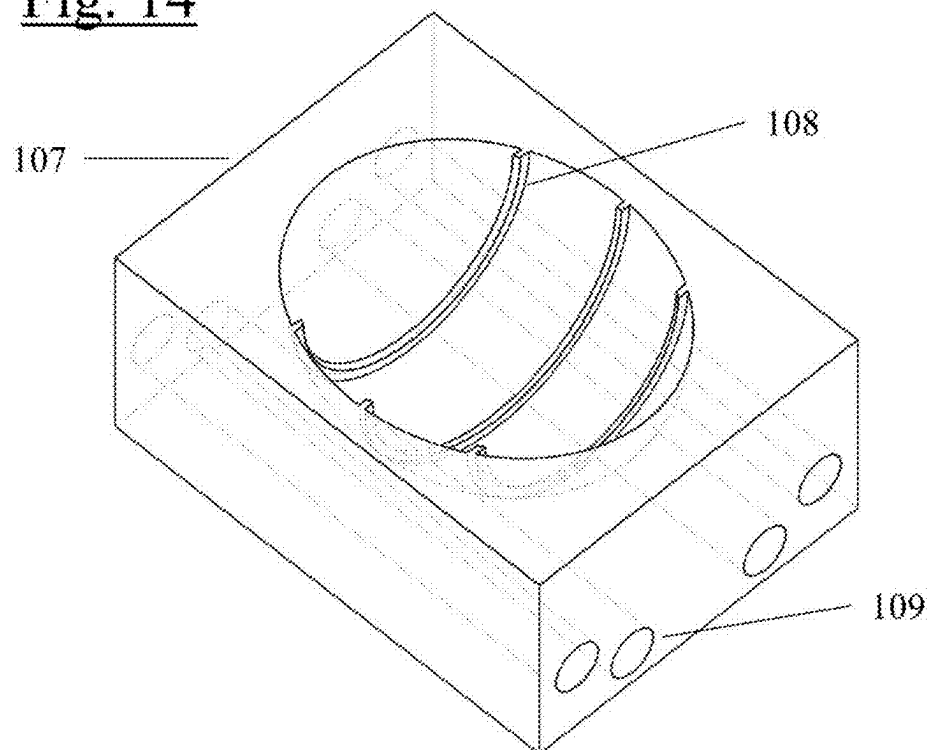


Fig. 15

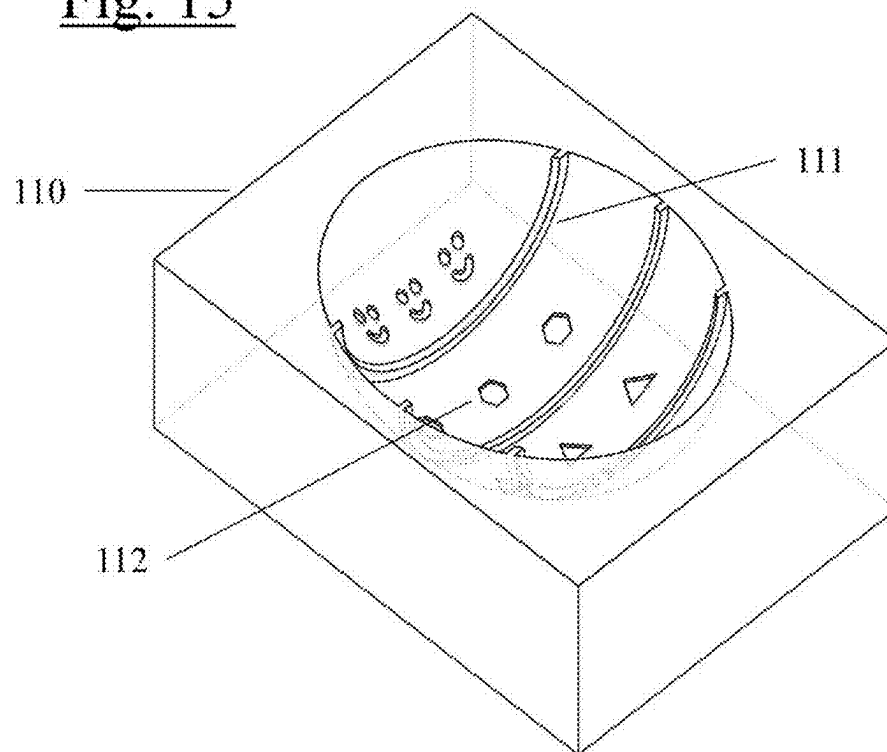


Fig. 16

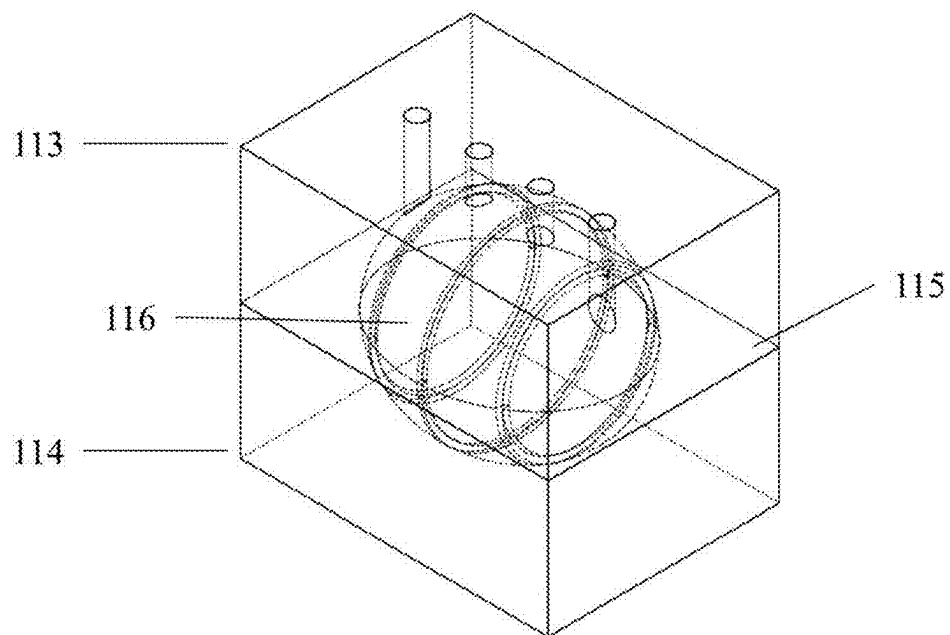


Fig. 17

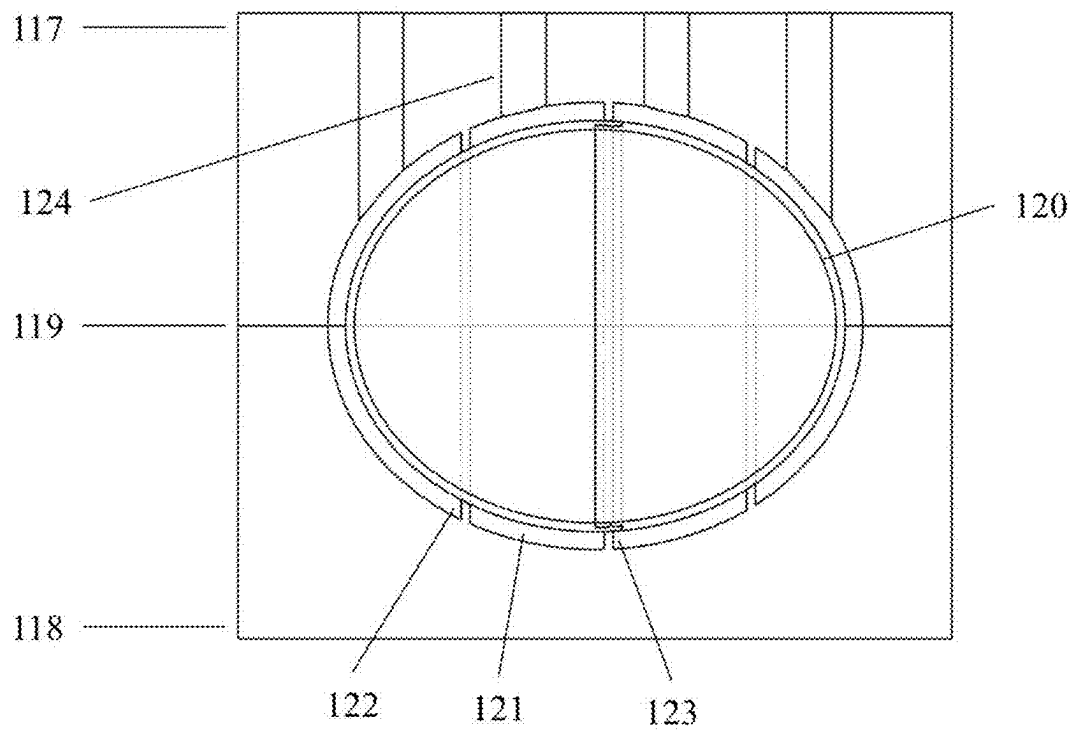


Fig. 18

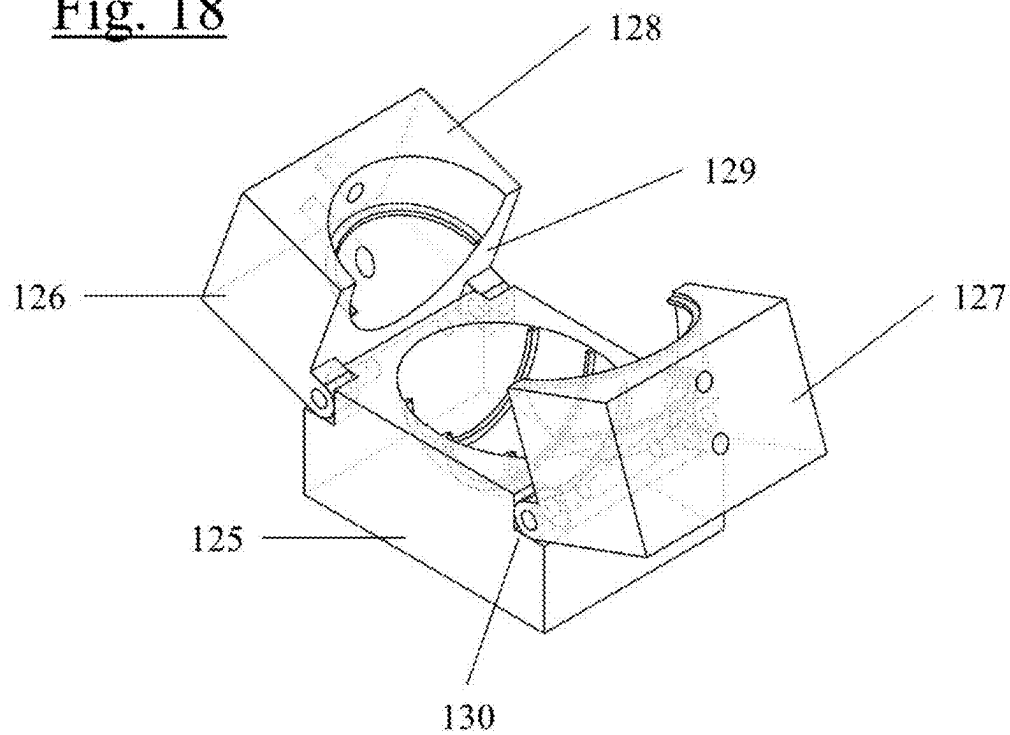
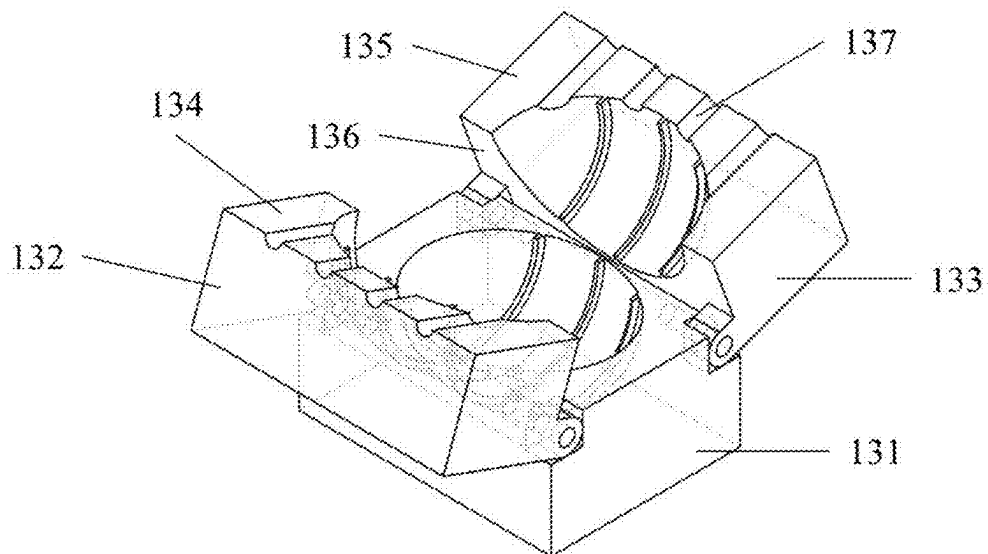


Fig. 19



GUMMY CONFECTIONERY-COATED NON-EDIBLE CONTAINER

[0001] TECHNICAL FIELD

[0002] This invention relates to the combination of an edible material with a non-edible object, particularly where the non-edible object is a container and contains a toy. The invention incorporates a layer of gelatinous gummy on the surface of the container as the edible material.

DESCRIPTION OF PRIOR ART

[0003] Numerous combinations of an edible material and a non-edible container have been described. Some examples that include confectionery-encapsulated toy containers are U.S. Pat. Nos. U.S. Pat. No. 20,110,123687A1, U.S. Pat. No. 5,925,391, U.S. Pat. No. 6,099,872, and US 20170050789A1, each of which is incorporated by reference in its entirety. All patents, patent applications, published applications and publications, websites and other published materials referred to throughout the entire disclosure herein, unless noted otherwise, are incorporated by reference in their entirety.

[0004] U.S. Pat. No. US20110123687A1 describes a separable shell wherein a ridge extends along the outer surface to aid in conveying to a child that there is non-edible material below the candy coating. US20170050789A1 describes a divisible container that may receive a first and second confectionery coating on each respective half, wherein the divisible container includes projections around the circumference to allow the user to see that a non-edible container is beneath. In these examples, however the confectionery coating is either, firstly, in two halves, divided by the protrusion, wherein the confectionery coating is not supported by the non-edible container, relying on packaging to retain the product's form; or secondly, the protrusion is discontinuous, allowing for the two coatings to be partially connected to increase the structural integrity.

[0005] Examples of gummy confectionery forming are described in U.S. Pat. Nos. US20040131751A1 and US6596334B1, each of which is incorporated by reference in its entirety.

[0006] U.S. Pat. No. US20040131751A1 describes a process for producing outer shells of confectionery by means of using a cold member to press a mass of liquid confectionery into a mould and form said confectionery into a cup shape. U.S. Pat. No. 20040131751A1 describes a means of producing confectionery that can receive a liquid centre filling within the formed confectionery cup.

[0007] U.S. Pat. No. US6596334B1 describes a method of producing gelled food shapes in which a liquid confectionery solution is deposited into shaped cavities within starch powder moulds. This starch mogul technique, and more recently, machines that utilize plastic or metal moulds are the current industry standard for gummy confectionery production. These methods, however, cannot produce hollow products nor would be able to incorporate encapsulated objects within the confectionery in such a way that the location of the encapsulated object, and the form of the final product is controllable.

BACKGROUND

[0008] Surprise toy products have created a popular segment in the toy industry, and it is continuing to grow. There are two key types of surprise toys: products that contain only

toys, and those that include confectionery or other food as an additional selling point. This invention's subject matter is related to the latter.

[0009] Some surprise toy confectionery products include a toy and a serving of confectionery as separately packaged items within an outer container; a product of note for this style is Ferrero's 'Kinder Joy'. Other products contain the toy inside a plastic container, often egg shaped or round in nature, and partially or completely encapsulate the container in chocolate; references for this style are Ferrero's 'Kinder Surprise', Candy Treasure LLC's 'Choco Treasure'—20110123687, and Yowie Group Ltd's 'Yowie'—US20170050789A1.

[0010] Due to Food and Drug Administration (FDA) regulations, in the U.S. it is prohibited to entirely conceal any non-nutritive product within a candy coating, due to § 402(d) (1) of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. This results in Kinder Surprise's design of an encapsulated, non-edible, toy container to be unavailable in the U.S. market. In the "Choco Treasure" and "Yowie" products, the capsule visibly protrudes through the confectionery layer, making it obvious to the consumer that there is a non-edible component inside. These products and many similar products all use chocolate as the confectionery layer.

[0011] Previous combinations of an edible material and a non-edible container have a number of shortcomings. For example, existing combinations of a confectionery edible material and a non-edible container are typically limited to chocolate as the confectionery. Compared to gelatine-based confectioneries such as gummy, chocolate is less flexible, and more brittle. Consumption of chocolate confectionery encapsulating a non-edible container typically involves fragmentation of the confectionery, and chocolate can partially melt from contact with heat from the user's fingers, adversely impacting the user's experience. Chocolate also can fragment or deform prior to consumption by the user. In addition, chocolate typically has one of only three colours: white, brown and black, and a limited flavour experience. Adding other colours to this limited colour palette of chocolate is difficult because addition of even small quantities of water to melted chocolate can disrupt the delicate balance of ingredients and form a gritty rough mass. In addition, many people adversely react to chocolate, such as by an allergic reaction to one or more ingredients. Thus, there is a need for alternative confectionery products for coating a non-edible container that can expand on the limited colour palette of chocolate, provide for alternative user experiences to interact with the confectionery, exhibit increased physical stability of the confectionery, and allow for consumption of confectionery by chocolate-adverse consumers.

[0012] Gummy confectionery is vibrant and can be readily prepared in different colours and flavours. However, current gummy confectionery products are not manufactured in a way that can accurately accommodate a partially, or fully, encapsulated solid object. Most gummy products are solid or have liquid centres. In 3D gummy manufacturing, gummy is loosely dripped into a mould, and gravity and vibration can settle the shape. No product in which gummy is formed around a solid non-edible object exists, nor is a process for preparing such a product known. There exists a need for a confectionery coated container that follows the legal standards in a safe and accessible form, as well as exploits other confectionery materials as the outer layer compared to traditional products. There exists a need for a gummy

confectionery-coated non-edible container that utilises an injection moulding production process to conform the confectionery to a non-edible container and allows spatial control over attributes of distinct sections of gummy confectionery product including, for example, attributes selected from among size, position, thickness, colour, flavour and texture.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

[0013] Accordingly, the present invention is directed to a gummy confectionery-coated object that obviates one or more of the limitations and disadvantages of the related art. In some embodiments, the present invention is directed to a gummy confectionery-coated non-edible container. Methods of manufacturing the gummy confectionery-coated non-edible object of non-edible container are also provided.

[0014] It is an objective of this invention to form the layer of gummy such that it may partially encapsulate the non-edible container to comply with FDA safety regulations when required. For purposes of this description, ‘encapsulation’ is defined by the non-edible container being completely covered by the gummy layer, whereas ‘partial encapsulation’ refers to incomplete coverage.

[0015] Furthermore, it is an objective of this invention to comprise the confectionery layer of multiple sections that are separable from adjacent sections by various physical features, such as a perforated line, a groove, an indentation, or a continuous vacancy, to achieve the aforementioned disclosure of the non-edible container to the consumer.

[0016] Furthermore, it is an objective of this invention to provide a method of manufacturing a gummy confectionery-coated non-edible object. This method can yield products that include the aforementioned features within, and between, each section of gummy with the use of an external mould which locates the non-edible container during the forming process.

[0017] An additional objective of this invention is to form the confectionery layer in such a method as to loosely adhere it to a surface of the non-edible container, wherein ‘loosely adhered’ is defined by: ‘adhered’ referring to the gummy layer’s capacity to remain in place on the container surface due to surface-to-surface adhesion, rather than protrusions from the non-edible container, connections to adjacent sections, or a combination thereof, that may traditionally provide support for other forms of confectionery; while ‘loosely’ refers to the ease in which the layer may be removably peeled from the container surface, wherein the layer is removed in a fashion that does not require a tool, and is reasonable for a child to remove with their fingers.

[0018] Furthermore, it is an objective of this invention to control the surface texture of the non-edible container and/or the formulation of the confectionery to create an experience which does not leave residue or substantially does not leave residue on the non-edible container following the layer being peeled from the surface.

[0019] It is also an objective of this invention to control the size and/or physical form of the non-edible container to ensure that it is not a choking hazard to the consumer.

[0020] Additional features and advantages of the invention will be set forth in the description which follows, and in part will be apparent from the description, or may be learned by practice of the invention. The objectives and other advantages of the invention will be realised and

attained by the structure particularly pointed out in the written description and claims hereof as well as the appended figures.

[0021] It is to be understood that both the foregoing general description and the following detailed description are exemplary and explanatory and are intended to provide further explanation of the invention as claimed.

DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0022] The accompanying drawings, which are included to provide further understanding of the invention are incorporated and constitute a part of this specification, illustrate embodiments of the invention and together with the description, serve to explain the principles of the invention.

[0023] In the drawings:

[0024] FIG. 1 shows a side view of a preferred embodiment of the invention; a non-edible container with a layer of 8 peelable sections of gummy confectionery.

[0025] FIG. 2 shows the same embodiment and view of FIG. 1, with one of the 8 sections partially peeled from the surface of the non-edible container.

[0026] FIG. 3 shows a cross sectional view of the invention’s embodiment from FIG. 1, revealing a toy within the non-edible container.

[0027] FIG. 4 shows a three-quarter perspective view of the invention’s embodiment from FIG. 1 with the confectionery layer removed from the non-edible container, and the toy being removed.

[0028] FIG. 5 shows a side view of a similar embodiment to FIG. 1, wherein the sections of removable gummy have unique colours from one another.

[0029] FIG. 6 shows a side view of an alternative embodiment of the invention, with an example of potential shapes of gummy confectionery sections.

[0030] FIG. 7 shows a side view of an alternative embodiment of the invention, wherein the sections of gummy form the design of a character on the surface of a non-edible container.

[0031] FIG. 8 shows a cross sectional view of an alternative embodiment of the invention, wherein the non-edible container’s shape may vary, such as a sphere, and/or the contents of the container may be food or other non-toy products.

[0032] FIG. 9 shows a cross sectional view of an alternative embodiment of the invention, wherein the non-edible container is a cube shape. An encapsulated toy is also revealed within the non-edible container.

[0033] FIG. 10 displays a cross sectional view of an alternative embodiment similar to FIG. 3, wherein the peelable sections of gummy confectionery are connected by an indented groove to assist with separation, instead of a gap.

[0034] FIG. 11 is a side view displaying an alternative embodiment similar to FIG. 1, wherein the peelable sections of gummy confectionery are connected by a perforated line to assist with separation, instead of a gap.

[0035] FIG. 12 is a three-quarter view of a first half of a mould which comprises a cavity that houses a non-edible object to form gummy confectionery on the outer surface of.

[0036] FIG. 13 is a three-quarter view of a second half of a mould which comprises a cavity that houses a non-edible object to form gummy confectionery on the outer surface of.

[0037] FIG. 14 shows three-quarter view of an alternative embodiment of FIG. 12, wherein the mould comprises water

channels through the body of the mould to cool the gummy confectionery after injecting the confectionery into the mould.

[0038] FIG. 15 is a three-quarter view of an additional alternative embodiment of the mould half of FIG. 12, wherein the inner surface of the mould has shapes and icons debossed into it.

[0039] FIG. 16 shows a three-quarter view of the mould halves from FIGS. 12 and 13 mated together, forming the non-edible object-housing cavity.

[0040] FIG. 17 is a cross-sectional side view of the mated mould halves from FIG. 16 with a non-edible container located within.

[0041] FIG. 18 shows a three-quarter view of an alternative embodiment of the mould from FIG. 16, wherein the second half is divided into two sections, through its transverse axis.

[0042] FIG. 19 shows a three-quarter view of an additional alternative embodiment of the mould from FIG. 16, wherein the second half is divided into two sections, through its longitudinal axis.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE INVENTION

[0043] As used herein, “longitudinal” refers to an axis along the lengthwise direction of a body passing through the centre of gravity.

[0044] As used herein, “transverse” refers to an axis along the width of a body, orthogonal to and intersecting the longitudinal axis at the centre of gravity.

[0045] The invention as disclosed in its present form, comprises of: A polypropylene non-edible container in the shape of an egg, wherein the longitudinal dimension is longer than its transverse dimension and is rotationally symmetrical about its longitudinal axis; A toy encapsulated within the non-edible container; A peelable layer made up of sections of gummy confectionery on the surface of said non-edible container, including gaps between these sections revealing the non-edible container underneath, wherein the gaps are preferably formed by an outer mould during the confectionery forming process.

[0046] Referring to FIGS. 1-5, this embodiment comprises of sections 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8 of gummy confectionery loosely adhered to the surface of a non-edible, egg-shaped, container 9, wherein the confectionery layer conforms to its shape. These confectionery sections 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8 are separable from adjacent sections by a gap 10 of 0.5 mm-2.5 mm. Each sections 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7 include a gap 11, 0.5 mm-2.5 mm in width, to assist with peeling 12 the confectionery from the surface of the container 9. Upon peeling the loosely adhered confectionery layer from the surface of the container, a residue-free finish 13 remains, due to the surface texture of the container 9, the formula of the gummy confectionery, or a combination thereof.

[0047] FIG. 3 illustrates a cross-sectional view of the embodiment, revealing the encapsulated toy 14 inside the non-edible container. Additionally, the gummy confectionery layer's profile 15 displays the intended thickness to be a thin layer of 1 mm-5 mm gummy conforming to the supporting curved surface.

[0048] FIG. 4 shows this embodiment's egg capsule 17, with the gummy confectionery removed from the surface, and opened into two halves 19, 20 allowing the toy 18 to be removed.

[0049] FIG. 5 displays a preferred design of the invention's present embodiment, wherein each of the gummy confectionery sections 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28 are individually coloured. Furthermore, each of these uniquely coloured sections are uniquely flavoured. For example, the flavours for such sections could be any of the following: cherry, strawberry, orange, pineapple, lemon, lime, apple, raspberry, grape, watermelon, mango, bubble gum, pink grapefruit, cola, chocolate, or a combination thereof.

[0050] The embodiment of the invention illustrated in FIG. 5 also displays the key features from FIGS. 1-4 of: sections of gummy confectionery loosely adhered to the surface of a non-edible, egg shaped, container 29 containing a toy, with a gap 30 between each section, and a gap 31 to assist with peeling said sections.

[0051] Referring to FIG. 6, this embodiment displays potential for alternative designs formed by the gummy confectionery sections 32, such as pentagons and hexagons, while still featuring the gaps 33 between adjacent shapes to reveal the non-edible container 34.

[0052] Referring to FIG. 7, this embodiment further displays alternative designs, that conform to the non-edible container 38, using various section shapes. Sections, separable by gaps 37, may form the design of objects, landscapes, or, in this embodiment, a character wherein the sections 35 may represent heads, arms and other features. Additionally, colour 36 may be used to add to the design cohesion between sections, wherein similar sections may share a colour and flavour, such as left and right arms, however differing sections such as hair may be a different colour and flavour.

[0053] Referring to FIGS. 8 and 9, these illustrations display embodiments of the invention wherein the non-edible container may be alternative shapes, such as a sphere 39, a cube 44, or any other shape that is beneficial to the product design. These embodiments would preferably support one or more sections 40, 45 of confectionery, each with a unique colour & flavour 41, 46. The section or sections could also comprise features within the section, to assist with peeling, and be separable from any adjacent sections by a gap 42, 47 or alternative features.

[0054] Furthermore, whereas FIG. 9 shows an encapsulated toy 48 within the non-edible container 44, FIG. 8 shows an embodiment of the invention wherein the encapsulated material 43 within the container 39, is not a toy, but alternative items such as jelly beans, chocolate, gummy or other food products.

[0055] FIG. 10 displays an alternative embodiment of the present invention wherein each independently removable section 49 is separable from adjacent sections 50, 51 by indented grooves, such as a V-shaped indentation 52.

[0056] FIG. 11 illustrates an embodiment showing an alternative form of the independently removable sections wherein each section 53 is separable from adjacent sections 54, 55 by a perforated tear line 56.

[0057] Referring now to FIGS. 12 to 17, these figures illustrate the method for producing a gummy confectionery-coated non-edible object. Additionally, alternative embodiments of this method are shown.

[0058] FIG. 12 displays a first half 101 of a mould that is used to prepare the aforementioned preferred embodiments of a gummy confectionery-coated non-edible container similar to FIG. 1. This mould shown comprises an inner surface that injected gummy confectionery conforms to and

protrusions offset from said inner surface to locate the non-edible container and form the aforementioned gummy confectionery sections. These protrusions include transverse ribs **102** that separate each section of gummy by a gap **10**, and a longitudinal rib **103** that creates a peeling gap **11** to allow the consumer to remove sections of gummy independently.

[0059] FIG. **13** displays the second half **104** of a mould designed to mate with the first half **101** from FIG. **12**. The transverse ribs **105** align with the ribs **102**, although this side does not feature a longitudinal rib. The second half **104** features injection holes **106**, to inject the gummy confectionery into, with this embodiment having **1** injection hole for each section of gummy.

[0060] FIG. **14** illustrates an alternative embodiment of a first half **107** of a mould that could mate with the second half **104** from FIG. **13**. This mould does not contain a longitudinal rib yet retains the transverse ribs **108** to provide multiple cavities for receiving gummy. This mould additionally comprises cooling channels **109** within the body of the mould that may allow for rapid cooling of the mould, and consequent cooling of the gummy confectionery. Alternatively, these cooling channels could also be designed to receive refrigerant, coolant liquid, or cold air.

[0061] FIG. **15** further displays an alternative embodiment of a first half **110** of a mould that could mate with the second half **104** from FIG. **13**. This mould half also retains multiple transverse ribs **111** for locating the non-edible container and creating discrete cavities, however the inner surface of the mould comprises debossed shapes **112**. This illustrates the ability to form complex geometry and texture into the formed gummy sections such as polygons, letters, symbols, icons, fruit, or any other features that may improve the sensation or appearance of the gummy.

[0062] FIG. **16** displays a preferred embodiment of a closed mould comprising a first **113** and second **114** half mated at a coupling face **115**. These two halves, when mated, form an interior cavity **116** capable of receiving a non-edible object that the protrusions and/or inner surface have been contoured to and/or offset from.

[0063] FIG. **17** further shows a cross-sectional view of two mould halves **117**, **118** mated at a coupling plane **119** containing a non-edible object, wherein the object is a non-edible container **120**. This view shows the fixed location of the non-edible container within the mould's contoured ribs and offset inner surface, and the separation of discrete cavities between the transverse ribs. The injection hole **124** allows for gummy to be injected into the cavity **121** between the transverse ribs **122**, **123**. The inner surface of the mould halves can be seen to be contoured and offset from the outer surface of the non-edible container, providing a vacancy with uniform thickness, wherein the resulting injected gummy sections would have uniform thickness.

[0064] Referring now to FIGS. **18** and **19**, in some alternative embodiments, the aforementioned second half of the mould could be further divided into two parts, through its longitudinal or transverse axis, wherein the dividing plane is perpendicular to the mating plane between the two halves. This division of the second half could produce a folding mould, wherein the mould comprises of a first half, and a second and third section that make up the second half, wherein these second and third sections are each independently connected, via a hinge or a linear rail, to the first half. Furthermore, this division of the second half could be useful

to ensure a lower surface area for the gummy confectionery to stick to compared to the first half when opening the mould after cooling. This would provide a more stable mould release process, wherein the gummy confectionery coated non-edible object remains in the first half of the mould upon opening the closed mould to remove the gummy confectionery-coated non-edible object.

[0065] FIG. **18** displays an alternative embodiment of the mould in FIG. **16**, wherein the mould comprises a first half **125** and a second half that is divided into a first **126** and second **127** section through its transverse axis. Upon closing the mould, each section of the second half would mate to the other with a face **128**, and with the first half of the mould with a face **129**, wherein faces **128** **129** are perpendicular. Each section of the second half in this embodiment is connected to the first half via a hinge **130**.

[0066] FIG. **19** illustrates an additional alternative embodiment of the mould in FIG. **16**, wherein the mould comprises of a first half **131** and a second half divided into a first **132** and second **133** section and connected via a hinge as in the embodiment of FIG. **18**, however, the second half in this embodiment is divided through its longitudinal axis. Each section of the second half mates with the other with the faces **134** **135** and with the first half of the mould with the face **136**, wherein the faces **134** **135** are perpendicular to **136**. This embodiment additionally divides the injection holes **137** which seal upon closing of the mould sections.

[0067] The present and alternative embodiments of the mould, for example, could be mated together using mechanisms such as a hinge, bolts, magnets, automated power screws, cam locks, linear slide rails or other well-known clamping methods.

[0068] The mould can be prepared from any suitable material, such as, for example, aluminium, stainless steel, silicone, or any combination thereof. Selection of a suitable material is within the ability of the skilled artisan. Characteristics of the material that can be considered include, for example, thermal properties, machining time, and durability. For example, a durable material can minimize damage to the mating surfaces after repeated clamping of the two mould halves.

[0069] The moulds for use in the methods provided herein can be coated with a permanent or temporary coating to decrease adherence of gummy confectionery to the mould surface. Decreasing adherence of gummy confectionery can facilitate release of the gummy confectionery-coated non-edible object from the mould. Examples of coatings that can be applied to the mould surface include Polytetrafluoroethylene (PTFE), Perfluoroalkoxy alkane (PFA), Fluorinated Ethylene Propylene (FEP), Ethylene Tetrafluoroethylene (ETFE), carnauba wax, corn oil, palm oil, or coconut oil. In some methods provided herein the mould can be sand-blasted, or otherwise roughened, before applying a permanent coating.

[0070] A gummy confectionery-coated non-edible container can be prepared by injection moulding gummy into a mould housing a non-edible container. In an exemplary embodiment, the gummy confectionery-coated non-edible container can comprise 8 sections of independently separable gummy coating, an egg-shaped non-edible container, and a surprise toy therein. Each confectionery section can contain a fruit flavour and a corresponding colour. The non-edible container can be made of polypropylene (PP) with a glossy white colour. Two sections of the non-edible

container can be attached by a snap joint to form a sealed container. The gummy confectionery coating can be applied by hot injection moulding within a PTFE coated mould, wherein the injection of gummy is controlled with a pump with adequate volume accuracy. After injection of hot gummy confectionery, the gummy confectionery can be cooled by cooling the mould with cold air or water.

[0071] The gummy confectionery can be prepared to meet an injection temperature suitable to control key parameters that may affect the forming process such as viscosity, or heat energy. As the temperature is increased, the viscosity decreases which may require lower injection pressure, however higher temperature may also result in longer cooling time of the mould and gummy confectionery layer.

[0072] Once the gummy is sufficiently set, the mould can be opened to remove the gummy confectionery-coated container where it can be left to dry in a humidity-controlled environment. This drying process can be used to achieve desired gummy texture and reduce the adhesion of the outer surface of the gummy layer. Once dried, a fine layer of vegetable oil & carnauba wax solution can be applied to improve glossiness and further reduce stickiness adhesive properties of the gummy surface.

[0073] The invention has been described with examples relevant to its current form, however, potential embodiments will include any form that is within the scope of the appended claims. It will be apparent to those skilled in the art that various modifications and variation can be made in the present invention without departing from the spirit or scope of the invention. Thus, it is intended that the present invention cover the modifications and variations of this invention provided they come within the scope of the appended claims and their equivalents.

[0074] 1-69. (canceled)

70. A method of preparing a gummy confectionery-coated non-edible object, comprising:

placing a non-edible object into a mold;
closing the mold; and

injecting gummy confectionery into the closed mold to form a plurality sections of gummy confectionery layer on an outer surface of the non-edible object;

wherein the plurality sections of gummy confectionery layer partially encapsulate the non-edible container and are separable by indented grooves, perforations, gaps, or a combination thereof, and are each individually removably peelable from the outer surface of the non-edible container.

71. A method of claim 70, wherein the mold comprises a first half and a second half, each with an inner surface, that mate together at their respective faces to form a hollow interior to house the non-edible object.

72. The method of claim 71, wherein the second half of the mold further comprises two sections that mate together to form the inner surface of the second half.

73. The method of claim 70, wherein the non-edible object is a non-edible container.

74. The method of claim 70, wherein one or more protrusions from an inner surface of the mold, when containing the non-edible object, centralizes the non-edible object within the mold.

75. The method of claim 70, wherein one or more protrusions from an inner surface of the mold, when containing the non-edible object, creates a plurality of discrete cavities between the inner surface of the mold and the outer surface of the non-edible object, wherein the injected gummy confectionery fills the plurality of discrete cavities.

76. The method of claim 75, wherein each of the plurality of discrete cavities comprises one or more injection holes.

77. The method of claim 70, wherein the inner surface of the mold comprises shapes, letters, fruit patterns, or any combination thereof embossed on the inner surface, wherein the gummy confectionery layer is debossed with the shapes, the letters, or the fruit patterns.

78. The method of claim 70, wherein the non-edible object is made of plastic.

79. The method of claim 70, further comprising cooling the injected gummy confectionery.

80. The method of claim 79, wherein the gummy confectionery is cooled by exposing the closed mold to air.

81. The method of claim 80, wherein a temperature of the air is between 0-10° C., inclusive.

82. The method of claim 79, wherein the injected gummy confectionery is cooled by at least partially immersing the closed mold into water.

83. The method of claim 79, wherein the mold comprises one or more cooling channels that passes through a solid section of the mold, the method further comprising flowing the water through the one or more cooling channels.

84. The method of claim 82, wherein a temperature of the water is 1-10° C., inclusive.

85. The method of claim 79, further comprising, after cooling the injected gummy confectionery:

opening the mold; and

removing the gummy confectionery-coated non-edible object;

86. The method of claim 70, wherein the gummy confectionery is injected at a temperature of 50-70° C., inclusive.

87. The method of claim 70, wherein the mold comprises an ejector pin.

88. The method of claim 70, wherein the inner surface of the mold comprises a non-stick coating.

89. The method of claim 88, wherein the non-stick coating comprises of Polytetrafluoroethylene (PTFE), Perfluoroalkoxy alkane (PFA), Fluorinated Ethylene Propylene (FEP), Ethylene Tetrafluoroethylene (ETFE), carnauba wax, corn oil, palm oil, coconut oil, or a combination thereof.

* * * * *